
AUSTRALIAN
ABORIGINAL
DOT PAINTING

AUSTRALIAN ABORIGINAL DOT PAINTING

Australian Aboriginal is how we call the people who has been leaving in the Australian continent for thousand of years.

Because they never developed a written language, the aboriginal people have for thousands of years used artistic designs and symbols to convey stories and messages which are incredibly important in their culture.



Simbols and their meaning



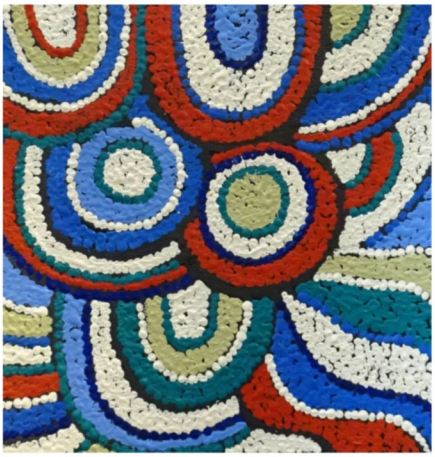




Traditional aboriginal dot paintings represent a story, generally regarding hunting or food gathering and usually have traditional aboriginal symbols imbedded throughout the painting. These symbols, when explained, give a completely whole new meaning to the painting.

The paintings consist of thousands of "Dots" and executed the traditional way, takes the artist hundreds of hours of committed attentiveness.

Dots symbolise stars, sparks, burnt ground etc. as ***the base of an Aboriginal painting is the organisation of the earth and the ancestral connection with it.***














Now that we know a little bit more about this wonderful kind of art, we want to create a painting that is similar in the style and process to those of the Australian aboriginal dot paintings.

What materials we need?

We need two main things: Paint and a surface to paint

Paint

> tempera or acrilic painting
> watercolor
> crayons
> color pencils
> pastels
...

Surface

> cardboard, watercolor paper
> cardboard box
> wooden board or plywood
> canvas
> piece of fabric
...

We will choose the surface to paint depending on the kind of painting that we have at home.
For example:

- If I have tempera or acrílic paint, I can paint on any of the surfaces.
- If I only have color pencils or markers and crayons, I can only use paper.

Are we forgetting something?

We still need a very important thing: ***the tool*** to paint
This can be anything that allows us to make a dot.
I give you some examples:

> Brushes (top and bottom can work)
> Q-tips (cotton little tips to clean your ears)
> Chopsticks
> Pencil, pen (top and bottom)
> Small stick or branch
...

let´s paint!!!

1. You need to think about the subject of your painting: a landscape, an animal, an abstract composition, geometric shapes, a portrait...
2. Draw as many sketches you need till you find what you like.
3. You can paint a flat color background and leave it dry before start doing the dot painting.
4. Remember that this painting is not spontaneous and fast but, in the contrary, it requires being patient, careful and meticulous.

You don't have to hurry, take your time and, the most important of all: ***enjoy this beautiful journey!!!***